Power BI Visualization Field Placement Cheat Sheet

■ CHART VISUALS

Visual	Category Field	Value Field	Legend / Color	Tooltip	Notes
Clustered Column	X → Text/Date	Y → Numeric	Text	Any	Category-wise comparison (vertical bars)
Clustered Bar	Y → Text/Date	X → Numeric	Text	Any	Same as column but horizontal
Stacked Column / Bar	Category → Text	Values → Numeric	Legend → Text	Any	Stack values per category
100% Stacked Column / Bar	Category → Text	Values → Numeric	Legend → Text	Any	Shows % contribution
Line Chart	X → Date/Text	Y → Numeric	Legend → Text	Any	Trends over time
Area / Stacked Area	X → Date/Text	Y → Numeric	Legend → Text	Any	Trends with filled area
Combo (Line + Column)	X → Text/Date	Y → Numeric	Legend → Text	Any	Compare two metrics
Pie / Donut	Legend → Text	Values → Numeric	—	Any	For share or % analysis
Treemap	Group → Text	Values → Numeric	—	Any	Hierarchical share view
Funnel	Stage → Text	Values → Numeric	—	Any	Stage-wise drop-off
Waterfall	Category → Text	Values → Numeric	—	Any	Increase/decrease analysis
Ribbon Chart	X → Category/Date	Y → Numeric	Legend → Text	Any	Ranking over time
Histogram	X → Numeric	Y → Frequency	—	Any	Distribution of numeric values

■■ MAP VISUALS

Visual	Category Field	Value Field	Legend / Color	Tooltip	Notes
Map	Location → Text	Size → Numeric	Color → Text/Numeric	Any	Geo-plot with bubbles
Filled Map	Location → Text	Color → Numeric/Text	—	Any	Color-shaded regions
Shape Map	Location → Text	Color → Numeric	—	Any	Region-based custom maps

■ CARD & KPI VISUALS

Visual	Category Field	Value Field	Legend / Color	Tooltip	Notes
Card	—	Value → Numeric	—	Any	Single metric display
Multi-row Card	—	Values → Numeric/Text	—	Any	Multiple KPIs together
KPI	Trend Axis → Date	Value → Numeric	Target → Numeric	Any	Goal tracking over time

Gauge	—	Value → Numeric	Target → Numeric	Any	Performance vs goal

■ TABLE & MATRIX VISUALS

Visual	Category Field	Value Field	Legend / Color	Tooltip	Notes
Table	Rows → Text	Values → Numeric	—	Any	Detailed row-wise data
Matrix	Rows/Columns → Text	Values → Numeric	—	Any	Pivot-style summary table
Table Heatmap	Rows/Columns → Text	Values → Numeric	Color → Numeric	Any	Color intensity for magnitude

■ ADVANCED / AI VISUALS

Visual	Category Field	Value Field	Legend / Color	Tooltip	Notes
Decomposition Tree	Explain By → Text	Analyze → Numeric	—	Any	Interactive breakdown
Key Influencers	Analyze → Numeric	Explain By → Text	—	Any	AI visual for drivers of metric
Q&A Visual	—	—	—	Any	Type question in natural language
Smart Narrative	—	—	—	—	Auto-summarizes data insights

■ QUICK MEMORY RULES

Rule	Meaning
Text = Axis / Legend	Categories, Names, Regions
Number = Values	Sales, Profit, Quantity, Count
Date = Time Axis	Year, Month, Quarter
Geo = Maps	Country, State, City
Any = Tooltip	Extra info on hover